

MAJID MUMTAZ, CIA, ACA, FCCA

Chief Audit Executive | Group Director of Internal Audit & GRC

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Chief Audit Executive with over 20 years of experience, including 15 years across the GCC, with a career built inside operational businesses: a cloud kitchen technology platform, a multi-sector JSC conglomerate spanning F&B, FMCG, retail, and healthcare, and advisory engagements across QSR, real estate, and hospitality operators. Held Chief Audit Executive accountability at both Kitopi and Al-Faisaliah Group — sole functional reporting line to the Audit Committee Chair, with the Audit Committee Secretary mandate held in tandem and findings escalated to the Board without management pre-approval. Known for deploying AI-enabled monitoring that moves audit coverage from statistical sampling to full-population assurance.

This work has recovered or neutralized AED 7.7M in vendor exposure, identified SAR 4M in procurement irregularities through forensic analysis, and surfaced SAR 15M in undisclosed litigation exposure on a USD 127M acquisition — used to renegotiate terms before closing.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Veritux Consulting Network

Dubai, UAE

Founder & Principal, Internal Audit & Risk Advisory

Jul 2025 – May 2026

- **GCC Advisory Practice:** Established and operated a solo advisory practice over a ten-month independent engagement period prior to seeking permanent in-house leadership; engagements spanned fraud risk policy reviews for a regional QSR operator, internal audit charter and manual development for a UAE property developer, and an internal audit diagnostic for a GCC F&B group covering governance structure, methodology, and reporting effectiveness.
- **Forensic Audit & ML Analysis:** Applied ML-enabled forensic analysis to a KSA real estate developer's project portfolio; identified SAR 4M in procurement irregularities across two project reviews, at a detection depth conventional audit sampling could not achieve.

Kitopi

Dubai, UAE

Cloud Kitchen Technology Platform | GCC Tech Scale-Up

Director of Internal Audit & GRC | Audit Committee Secretary

Jun 2022 – May 2025

- **Function Leadership:** Built and led the internal audit and GRC function from the ground up, with sole functional reporting line to the Audit Committee Chair; structured a team of 5 (including 1 manager) across operational risk, IT governance, ethics, and special investigations; designed and executed the risk-based annual audit plan, presenting it to the Audit Committee within three months of joining.
- **Audit Committee Secretary:** Ran the Audit Committee's governance machinery under pre-IPO scrutiny — agenda, board papers, minutes, and in-camera sessions with external auditors and the AC Chair; combined audit director and AC Secretary mandates gave the Board a single, unfiltered escalation channel for findings, investigation outcomes, and disclosure-sensitive matters ahead of IPO readiness milestones.
- **Operational Risk Assurance:** Designed the audit assurance strategy; directed the in-house build of a Python-based ML anomaly detection and Deep Learning OCR pipeline, developed by the internal audit team, to achieve full-population invoice coverage during a 340% surge in transaction volume; reduced fraud incidents by 78%, with programme outcomes and fraud metrics presented to the Audit Committee on a quarterly basis.

- **IT Governance & Cybersecurity Assurance:** Designed the ITGC framework for a rapidly scaling cloud platform; directed group-wide cybersecurity assessments and penetration testing that identified critical exposures, leading to the selection of a managed security contractor and a remediation programme that closed all identified material vulnerabilities.
- **Digital Governance:** Directed audit oversight of the Group's G-Suite to Microsoft 365 migration; independent validation confirmed full data integrity: zero data loss or integrity issues across the migration.
- **IPO Governance Readiness:** Established the ICFR programme from scratch for the pre-IPO roadmap; EY's external readiness attestation confirmed zero material weaknesses and zero significant deficiencies.
- **Ethics Programme & Whistleblowing:** Owned the Group's ethics and whistleblowing programme end-to-end: led competitive selection of NAVEX EthicsPoint, designed the case management framework and escalation protocol, and reported case status directly to the Audit Committee; the programme established a functioning speak-up culture with genuine organisational reach; case management, escalation, and remediation were tracked independently through to Board-level reporting.
- **Special Investigations:** Led multiple sensitive internal investigations, including a CAPEX governance breach inquiry, with findings reported directly to the Audit Committee; 95% of findings substantiated and 99% of required actions tracked to closure, each case managed end-to-end from design through evidence handling to Board reporting.
- **Commercial Integrity Monitoring:** Recovered AED 3.2M in vendor overcharges and neutralized AED 4.5M in future exposure through automated, continuous monitoring.
- **Audit Transformation:** Directed the build-out of a continuous transaction monitoring capability across seven audit domains, covering flagging logic, workflow routing, and exception reporting; shifted the function from periodic reviews to ongoing real-time monitoring; maintained management action tracking through to closure, with overdue items escalated directly to the Audit Committee.

Al-Faisaliah Group (JSC)

Riyadh, KSA

Diversified Conglomerate: F&B, FMCG, Retail, Healthcare & Pharma

Group Director of Internal Audit & Risk | Audit Committee Secretary

Nov 2016 – May 2022

- **IIA External Quality Assessment:** Achieved the IIA 'Generally Conforms' rating — the IIA's top rating on external quality assessment — confirming full conformance with IIA Standards across methodology, independence, and governance.
- **Board-Level Governance Reporting:** Ran the Audit Committee's governance machinery across a five-sector JSC portfolio (F&B, FMCG, retail, healthcare, pharma) — coordinated cross-sector audit reporting, group-level risk consolidation, related-party and supplier-conduct escalations, and revised Board and committee charters adopted by the holding company; combined audit director and AC Secretary mandates ensured the holding-company Board received findings unfiltered by subsidiary management.
- **M&A Due Diligence:** Led internal due diligence on a USD 127M acquisition, identifying SAR 15M in undisclosed litigation exposure; findings were used to renegotiate terms before closing.
- **Function Professionalization:** Grew the internal audit team from 3 to 20 professionals, managing the department budget and resource allocation across the Group.
- **Enterprise Risk Management (ERM):** Built a Board-commissioned ERM framework consolidating Group-wide risk exposure; framework directly informed an insurance strategy overhaul at the Group's F&B subsidiary that reduced premiums by approximately 15%, and underpinned revised Board and committee charters, adopted by the holding company's Audit Committee, through which portfolio risks were measured against the Group's stated risk appetite.
- **Special Investigations:** Led multiple special investigations across the Group's portfolio — including related-party concerns and supplier conduct — with direct Audit Committee reporting throughout; sustained a 95% substantiation rate and 99% action closure rate across the portfolio.

- **Cybersecurity Vendor Governance:** Led the competitive selection and onboarding of AT&T as Group MSSP, consolidating fragmented in-house security coverage into 24/7 managed threat monitoring across all Group entities.
- **Financial Controls (ICFR):** Designed and implemented the ICFR programme for the Group's F&B subsidiary, establishing its first structured financial reporting control environment; the programme passed EY's external audit with no major control deficiencies identified.
- **Fraud Prevention & Detection:** Generated SAR 4.2M in annual savings through predictive ML-enabled monitoring of procurement and supplier payment processes, delivered via a specialist forensic analytics vendor under audit-defined rule logic and exception thresholds.

EARLIER CAREER & BIG 4 FOUNDATION

Manager, Internal Audit McDonald's Saudi Arabia	2014 – 2016
Internal Audit Manager KPMG (Qatar)	2011 – 2013
AVP, Internal Audit BMA Asset Management	2010 – 2011
Audit Manager Ernst & Young (Karachi, Pakistan)	2004 – 2009

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- The CFO Is the Audit Independence Risk You're Not Managing, *GRC Report*
- Keeping Risk Registers Relevant, *ACCA AB Magazine*
- FCPA Compliance Programs Are Missing Important Nuances About How Bribery Works in the Persian Gulf, *Corporate Compliance Insights*
- Teaching an Algorithm to Filter False Flags, *IIA Internal Auditor Magazine (Voices)*
- AI Authorization Is Not AI Accountability, *GRC Report*
- The Risk of Algorithmic Entropy: When AI Models Age Faster Than Evolving Fraud, *Consultancy ME*

EDUCATION, CREDENTIALS & EXPERTISE

- **Core Credentials:** CIA, ACA, FCCA
- **Degree:** B.Com, Karachi University (2003)
- *ACCA qualification: UK Master's degree equivalent (UK ENIC)*

Governance & Audit Frameworks: IIA Standards | COSO ERM & ISO 31000 | ICFR / SOX | COBIT | ISO 27001 | NIST CSF | Third-Party Risk | Forensic Investigations | Cyber-security Assurance

GCC Regulatory & Compliance Exposure: UAE SCA (listed-company governance) | KSA CMA Corporate Governance Regulations | ZATCA e-Invoicing & VAT | UAE Corporate Tax | UAE Economic Substance Regulations (ESR) | UAE AML / Beneficial Ownership | Saudi Companies Law

Audit Technology: AI/ML-enabled continuous monitoring | Deep Learning OCR | Python-based automation | NAVEX EthicsPoint | ITGC & Cloud Governance | SAP | Oracle | O365/G-Suite

Executive Certifications: Disruptive Strategy (Harvard Business School) | Enterprise Risk Management (COSO) | Information Systems Auditing & IT Governance (HKUST) | Machine Learning with Python (IBM) | Forensic Accounting & Fraud Examination (WVU) | Risk Management Specialization (NYIF)